

Old Commerce - Part 2

by Adrian King



Leonard Lane - Hurdle and Spar Maker in Hayters Way. 1940's. His son-in-law X Bond continued with the business into the 1980's. Wilfred Foster and Fred Sims also were Hurdle and Spar Makers at Cripplestyle.

Meedons Demolition Breakers Yard in Station Road - 1980's.

Moonacre Restaurant - A restaurant at Presseys Corner owned by Barbara Garnsworthy. Occupied the bakery and grocers, it is now a domestic house.

Sidney Osment - Village Milk Round. He took over Eric Wallis's round.

Palmer's Stores - A shop at Charing Cross. See also **Pressey's Stores**.

Parade Butchers - Butchers at "The Halt." - 1980's.

David Pattle - Electrical contractor in Hillbury Road.

Pet Shop - Station Road near Down Lodge Close run by Michael and Jean Cull - 1980's. Now a private house.

Pinhorns Nursery, Hillbury Road - Ron and Adrian Pinhorn. Now housing.

D. Philpott - Motor Engineer in Fordingbridge Road - 1975.

Presseys Nursery (Sumach) - Also known as Station Road Nurseries in 1973. A nursery in Station Road that was owned by Herbert Pressey. Bert Pressey had a



Leonard Lane and his son Peter.

swimming pool in one of the greenhouses. It has been used by the Congregational Church for baptisms on occasions. In the early 2000's the whole plot which consisted of two houses (30 Station Road, "Woodleigh" and 34 Station Road, "Sumach") and greenhouses was divided up and developed.

The greenhouses were demolished for housing with access from Lime Tree Close and Apple Tree Road on Earlswood. Another dwelling was built in between the original houses on Station Road (32 Station Road).



Wilfred Foster at Cripplestyle.



An aerial view of Station Road Nurseries.

Woodleigh, before it was sold, was used as the manse for the Stuckton Group of Congregational Churches.

Presseys Stores and Bakery - At Presseys corner. After 1904 the shop was run by James William Palmer. The Palmers moved to a new shop at Charing Cross in 1915. Brian Palmer, son of William George Palmer (one of James William Palmer's sons) told how his father told him "how they used to stack the oven with "Faggots" of wood and set fire to it, they then drew out the ashes and in went the bread. The village bakery was a gathering place for the lads on cold winter nights. Dad said that after the fire had burnt out, they would draw the ashes and put in the bread to bake. He used to "knock back" the dough, and, he said, "No matter how dirty your hands were when you started that job, they were clean when you finished it!!" I bet the bread tasted better than the bread we get now though. All this was before and during the Great War of 1914-18. Because Dad was the village baker he was not called up."



Charing Cross showing Palmer's Stores and Henry and Godrick Sims' Blacksmiths Workshop.



Presseys Bakers and Grocers Delivery Van.

Thomas William Pressey purchased the store in 1926. In 1939 he is down as the owner and Leonard Candy the proprietor.

Until covered, there was a substantial mural on the wall of the bakehouse. The bakehouse and vehicle garages have been demolished in recent years and replaced with a house on the same site.

Mr. and Mrs James were the last business owners of the stores. When the stores closed the building became the Moonacre Restaurant.

Thomas William Pressey also had a grocery shop in Sandleheath in what was until recently (28th April 2023) the Post Office and Stores.

Sawyer, Reginald Ernest - Boot repairer in Camel Green, KA1939.

Clifford M. Sims - Broom Maker in Camel Green Road – 1930's.

Sunflower Coaches - Coach Hire in Hayters Way - 1940's.

Undertaking - Fred Hibberd did undertaking, cabinet making and decorating.

Vending Machines - There were Vending Machines in a bungalow opposite the News Agent and Wool Shop where you could get cigarettes and bars of chocolate.



James William Palmer, his wife and family at their shop on Presseys Corner

Barry Wallis - Funeral Director - 153 Station Road. Barry had a workshop and Chapel of Rest at the junction of Hillbury Road with Station Road.

After his death, the plot was sold to Alderholt Congregational Chapel. The new building is partly built on that land. The workshop was demolished but the Chapel of Rest remains and is used as a prayer room.

C & A Wallis Brothers - Coal Merchants in the Station Yard - 1930's.

Eric Wallis - A Milk Dairy in Station Road. Sidney Osment took over the round.

Peter Wallis - Operated a Paraffin Round in the village.

Whites Nursery - Nursery in Blackwater Grove run by Stan White. Was also a Newsagent.



The Halt in 1991. Alderholt Butchers, Alderholt Motors, an Estate Agent (Irvings), Hairline, the Post Office and General Store and Petrol Pumps operated from these premises. Now housing and only Alderholt Motors remains! Internet Picture.

This completes an incomplete survey of old commerce in the village (there are many more) - one wonders why now, with a population of 3000 that the village has so little enterprises as there were in past years!



Birch Hill - Fred Hibberd lived in the house on the left and the building centre right was his workshop for the undertaking business.



Sunflower Coaches - Hayters Way